(4) Moral Agency - Replication (#75141)

Authors
This pre-registration is currently anonymous to enable blind peer-review.
It has 5 authors.

Pre-registered on:
2021/09/20 12:16 (PT)

1) Have any data been collected for this study already?
No, no data have been collected for this study yet.

2) What's the main question being asked or hypothesis being tested in this study?
People more likely to sabotage:
• Will be in the moral agency condition
• Will provide justifications based on their personal values such as seeking justice or being virtuous

People more likely to de-escalate and help:
• Will be in the compliance condition
• Will provide justifications based on company policy reasons

3) Describe the key dependent variable(s) specifying how they will be measured.
Our key dependent variable will be how likely the participants will endorse either retaliatory response behaviors or deescalatory response behaviors. We will provide the same list of behaviors and ask questions in each condition relating to the extent to which participants would actually do them, as such:

Compliance Condition
• Deserve: Based on the Service Policy's trust of you to make decisions that reflect the mission of SerVest, to what extent does the customer deserve the following responses:
• Actual: Based on the Service Policy's trust of you to make decisions that reflect the mission of SerVest, how likely is it that you would:

Agency Condition
• Deserve: Based on the Service Policy's trust of you to make decisions that reflect your values, to what extent does the customer deserve the following responses:
• Actual: Based on the Service Policy's trust of you to make decisions that reflect your values, how likely is it that you will:

The behaviors will be measured on a 5-point Likert scale (Not at all likely (1) – Extremely likely (5)):
1. Refuse to address the customer's issue even though you could
2. Intentionally put the customer on hold for a long period of time
3. Purposefully transfer the customer to the wrong department
4. Purposefully disconnect the call
5. Tell the customer that you fixed the issue, even though you didn't fix it
6. Try to deescalate the situation over the phone
7. Seek assistance from a colleague or manager
8. Fix their issue as fast as possible
9. Tough it out by disregarding the customer's behaviors
10. Politely ask the customer to refrain from these behaviors

In this replication study (which is Study 3 of the Moral Agency project):
• The order of the vignettes will be randomized.
• There will be a longer time limit on the prompts.
• For the reasons section, the participants will be given the option to select as many from that list as they felt applied.

4) How many and which conditions will participants be assigned to?
Participants will be assigned to one of two between-subjects priming conditions (compliance, agency).

5) Specify exactly which analyses you will conduct to examine the main question/hypothesis.
The study has two hypotheses. The first will be examined with a two way analysis of variance (2x3) to test the effect of the condition (agency vs compliance) and vignette (1 vs 2 vs 3) on prosocial behavioral responses. The second hypothesis will similarly require an ANOVA except the dependent variable will be antisocial behavioral response. The focal result will be the main effect of condition, which will tell us whether increased agency is associated with more antisocial responses and increased compliance is associated with more prosocial responses.

6) Describe exactly how outliers will be defined and handled, and your precise rule(s) for excluding observations.
We will exclude participants who fail either of the attention checks embedded in the procedure, or the final item of the survey asking about attention. The attention checks in this replication study will differ from the original study. Check 1 will be a simple binary choice response (with a third "I have no idea" option available). Check 2 will also be a binary response. Failure of check 1 or 2 will entail any responses other than the single

response indicating the participant paid attention.

7) How many observations will be collected or what will determine sample size? No need to justify decision, but be precise about exactly how the number will be determined.

We aim for 240 participants, to allow for 100 per condition, and at least 40 exclusions due to inattention (failure of attention checks) or failing to complete the study.

8) Anything else you would like to pre-register? (e.g., secondary analyses, variables collected for exploratory purposes, unusual analyses planned?)

For exploratory purposes, we will also ask for participant's reasons for their selected response behaviors and analyze them in relation to the primary findings.